



Dundee Sailing and Rowing Club

May 2026 Newsletter

Yolanda Archibald

8th May 2026

Commodore's Corner

Hello everyone,

I'm not quite sure where the last month has gone, but it's certainly been a busy one around the club! It's been great to see so much happening both on and off the water, with lots of members getting involved and supporting the club.

It's also lovely to see some new faces joining both sailing and rowing over the past few months. A very warm welcome to all our new members - we hope you enjoy being part of the club, both on and off the water.

One of the great things about the club is that members can get involved in both sailing and rowing, so if you've only tried one activity so far, why not give the other a go too? There's always something happening around the club and you can have a cup of tea/coffee and a bit of a chat once you're back off the water.

Work Party

Our latest work party took place on 2nd May, with everyone getting the boats shipshape and ready for the Open Day. There were plenty of busy bees about, doing repairs, tidying, slipway, cutting the grass and preparations all happening at once, and there was a hive of activity. Our next work party is on Saturday 6th June at 10am, please come along. We're hoping to brighten things up with some painting at the clubhouse, along with the usual jobs, and there's always a good chat while the work gets done!

Fancy helping brighten the place up?

If anyone fancies helping organise or take the lead on some of the painting jobs, that would be very welcome too.

Safety Boats

A big thanks to Chris and Stuart for the huge amount of work they've been putting into the safety boats and engines recently. Their time and effort behind the scenes are very much appreciated, and without the safety boats, our sailing activities couldn't take place.

We're hoping to organise some powerboat training for the club members soon, which should be a great opportunity for anyone interested in helping on the safety boats. More details to follow soon.

Curry Night

Our Curry Night was a great success, with 28 members coming along for a fun-filled evening sampling a fantastic variety of Indian cuisine, enjoying good company and Clive's quiz, which certainly kept everyone entertained. A huge thank you to the Party Planners for all their hard work that went into organising the evening, cooking, and transforming the clubhouse with wonderful, themed decorations, candles and flowers – it really created a lovely atmosphere and helped make the night such a success.

Sailing

The sailing season is now well under way, with boats heading out on Tuesday, Thursdays and weather permitting the weekend sailing will take place, with a decision made during the week whether it will be Saturday or Sunday. Although a couple of sessions have been cancelled because of the weather, there has still been plenty of happening on the water, with a few younger sailors out in the toppers alongside some beginners getting their first taste of sailing.

On a Saturday/Sunday, sailors have also managed to get out on some longer sails and venture further afield, making the most of the better weather and, at times, taking on some challenging conditions out on the water as well!

The safety boats have also been busy the sailing sessions, with a helm and crew out on the water keeping an eye on the boats and sometimes managing to get some great photos and video clips, giving everyone a chance to see boats out on the water from a different angle - and a few very impressive action shots have appeared along the way – while making sure everyone stays roughly pointing in the right direction.

Rowing

The Wormit 2 Bridges Row took place on 26th April, and it turned into a fantastic day. With the first crew rowing over to Wormit before the second crew took over to row through both bridges and back home. Some of the rowers also managed to row through the bridges too, which added to what was a really great day. Wormit once again made us feel very welcome, and as always, the hospitality and food went down very well after a day on the water – Thanks to Wormit.

The regatta rowers have certainly been putting the effort in with some very early starts with some members discovering that rowing does exist before most people are even awake. We have four teams training hard for the Broughty Ferry regatta on Saturday 30th May, and it's been great to see the commitment and team spirit from everyone involved.

RP Assessment

Congratulations to Phil and Gordon on successfully completing their RP assessment and becoming designated RP's! They did a fantastic job on the water, especially while dealing with all sorts of unexpected situations (with a few challenges added in by the motley crews) during the assessment. They took it all in their stride with great patience and good humour.

Evening Talks

We recently held two more evening talks at the club, with Clive giving a practical session on Knots on 16th April, followed by Linda talking on The Role of the Cox on 29th April.

If anyone has ideas for future talks, topics they would like to be covered, please get in touch. We look to restart these later in the year and it would be good to see a few more faces along when they start up again.

Maintenance Help

We'd also love to find someone who might be willing to help head up some of the maintenance jobs around the club. While Derik has kindly taken on the role of the Bosun for the skiffs, it would be great to build a few folk who enjoy practical jobs and don't mind lending a hand now and again with things like woodwork, fiberglass, repairs, painting or general maintenance.

It doesn't necessarily need to be a club member so if you know a friend, family member, retired tradesman or keen DIY-er who might fancy helping occasionally, we'd love to hear from you. Even a few hours here and there can make a huge difference.

We are also trying to find someone who may be able to help with towing the skiff to events and regattas. Linda has kindly been making enquiries and has managed to contact a local towing/breakdown service which could possibly help at a cost. It would still be good if we could find someone connected to the club who might be willing to help with towing from time to time, if anyone has any ideas, please get back.

Social Media & Publicity

A big thanks to Mandy, Michelle, Mark and Mary, who have been helping get the club's Instagram up and running alongside the Facebook page. They've been busy taking photographs and video clips and sharing information about the club activities and events, which is a great way of helping promote the club and keep folk up to date. So, keep an eye out - you never know who will appear in a photo!

A big thank you as well to Stacy for putting together the graphics for the new reusable outdoor panners promoting our Open (Fun) Day - they look great and have brightened the place up!

Club Development

A big thank you to Lorraine and Maria, who have kindly offered to help support some of the club's longer-term development and fundraising work behind the scenes. There's a lot involved in pulling information together and exploring possible opportunities for the club, and their help and enthusiasm is very much appreciated.

Upcoming Events

- FIFIE Friday – Elie Thursday 14th May & North Queensferry 26th June
- Broughty Ferry Regatta – Saturday 30th May
- Forfar Fun Regatta – Saturday 20th June
- Midsummer Sailing with camping at Perth - 21st June
- TEWSH/Gala Day regatta (sailing and rowing) – Sunday 5th July
- Portsoy Trip – 25-28th August

- DSRC Beach Bonfire Night, live music with the Doolichters in the boathouse – Friday 28th August
- Forfar Regatta – Saturday 17th October

Further longer trips can be found on the club calendar and sailing programme.

Information

You can find lots of information on the club website, including our club calendar, sailing programme, Training material, Weather and lots more. It's a great way to keep up with what's happening in the club, so please have a look and make the most of it.

There's certainly no sign of things slowing down around the club any time soon, with plenty still to come over the summer months.

Here's to good company, safe sailing, strong rowing and hopefully a bit more sunshine along the way!

Yolanda

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